

WORTH EXPLORING

Brieanna Preston | 2026
**Independent Product
Project**

Career directions, not career answers.

What if better career decisions started with better things to test — instead of better predictions about who we should become?

Product concept · Methodology · UX · AI system design · Testing · AI-assisted development

01. THE QUESTION

CAREER EXPLORATION HAS AN ANSWER PROBLEM

A lot of career discovery starts with some version of:
Tell us about yourself → we'll tell you what fits.

But several things kept bothering me about that model.

- GOOD AT ≠ ENJOY DOING
- CAPABLE OF ≠ ENERGIZED BY
- INTERESTING ≠ SUSTAINABLE
- CURIOSITY ≠ COMPETENCE
- WHAT I'VE DONE ≠ WHAT I WANT MORE OF

Worth Exploring grew from two connected problems:

- Career tools can mistake prediction for exploration.
- The work people consider is constrained by what they know exists.

The design challenge became: *expand the field of possibilities without replacing uncertainty with false certainty.*

Worth Exploring

CAREER DIRECTIONS, NOT ANSWERS

EXPLORATORY REPORT

Your Work, Reconsidered

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02. THE TIMELINE

An earlier project, Day Job, explored career exposure through ideas like job shadowing, practitioner stories and reflection. The underlying question stuck. The operating model was enormous.

So I narrowed the problem:

WHAT IS THE SMALLEST USEFUL THING I COULD ACTUALLY BUILD AND TEST?

Instead of trying to improve career prediction, I became interested in improving the exploration process itself.



Day Job

Concept refinement

Worth Exploring

Conceptual reconstruction of the project evolution.

Your Work, Reconsidered

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What Kept Showing Up

LIVE SYSTEM ORCHESTRATION

Your answers show a strong pull toward seeing the whole operational picture in high-stakes, live environments. You notice breakdown points before they happen and care deeply that every moving part has clear ownership.

REAL TIME PROBLEM SOLVING

You are drawn to acting as a hands-on fixer when plans shift. Rather than sitting isolated at a desk, you prefer active coordination where your quick judgment keeps dynamic projects moving forward.

Where the Battery Might Die

- Full-cycle recruitment, talent sourcing, or high-touch corporate HR coordination.
- A role where 'quick sync?' is less an invitation and more a constant interruption to your deep focus.
- Environments requiring live public speaking, keynote presentations, or group workshop facilitation.
- Hierarchical corporate structures filled with rigid oversight, bikeshedding, and endless alignment meetings.

What's Worth Exploring

HYPOTHESIS 01

Information Architecture + Health Systems

Your explicit frustration with fragmented medical documentation converges with your flow in deep solo research and analytical decision-making. This overlap suggests an investigation into how health data and complex information flows can be organized into unified visual or text-based structures. What remains unclear is whether your interest is specific to healthcare or applies to complex data taxonomies across multiple sectors.

People in This Neighbourhood

Real roles where these patterns show up.

Technical Director

This role balances artistic production demands with technical setup, site logistics, and live problem-solving.

Worth noticing: Notice how they balance advance planning with emergency adjustments when equipment or timelines break down on site.

Your Next 30 Days

WEEK 1

Keep a brief observation log of 3 fragmented systems or confusing information layouts you encounter in daily life (such as a convoluted medical form, a cluttered app, or disorganized documentation).

This helps you notice what types of structural friction instinctively trigger your analytical interest without forcing you to build a fix yet.

03. THE SYSTEM

HOW IT WORKS

REFLECT

Approximately 16 questions about curiosity, energy, preferences, constraints and the mechanics of work.

NOTICE

The system synthesizes recurring patterns rather than assigning a personality type.

HYPOTHESIZE

It generates a few possible directions worth investigating — not a 'best career.'

GROUND

Real, searchable occupations show where pieces of those patterns exist in the working world.

TEST

A 30-day plan turns the ideas into small real-world experiments.

PATTERN ID

SEARCHABILITY

04. FROM ANSWERS TO EVIDENCE

CAREER EXPLORATION
AS A FEEDBACK LOOP

WEEK 1 - NOTICE

Map three live or recent events you attended or observed, taking simple notes on where ownership was clear, where friction occurred, and where a backup plan was missing.

This helps you build an evidence trail of the specific operational breakdowns that naturally trigger your fixer instincts without forcing you to solve them yet.

WEEK 2 - MAKE

Draft a single-page operational runsheet and emergency contingency map for a hypothetical 200-person event or temporary installation.

This creates a low-stakes artifact that tests how much you enjoy building order out of spatial, technical, and human logistics.

WEEK 3 - LOOK OUTWARD

Browse publicly available production schedules, technical riders, call sheets, and logistics job descriptions across festival, museum, and field management domains.

This lets you compare how different industries describe the day-to-day balance between advance planning and live troubleshooting.

WEEK 4 - COMPARE

Review your notes and runsheet alongside the job descriptions you found to observe which scale of live work felt energizing and which felt heavy or excessively administrative.

This puts the month's evidence side by side so you can notice which forms of work felt interesting, sustainable, draining, or unexpectedly appealing.

Originally, it would have been easy to stop at:

QUESTIONNAIRE → AI ANALYSIS → CAREER IDEAS

But AI can only interpret what someone says about themselves. It cannot establish what happens when they actually experience the work.

So the methodology moved toward:

NOTICE → HYPOTHESIZE → TEST → EXPERIENCE → REFLECT → UPDATE

"I tried it and hated it" can still be a successful outcome. The user now has evidence they didn't have before.

For career-fit decisions, evidence becomes more useful as it moves toward lived experience:

USER SAID → AI INFERRED → USER TESTED → USER CONFIRMED / REJECTED

The closer the process gets to lived experience, the less it needs to rely on prediction.

05. TESTING THE METHODOLOGY

EARLY OUTPUTS EXPOSED A RANGE PROBLEM.

Some of the first reports were convincing.
Maybe too convincing.

They repeatedly drifted toward language
like: *strategy · systems · research · consulting*
· *UX · knowledge work*

That raised a more important question than
whether I liked the output: **Had I accidentally
built a career tool that was especially good
at recognizing people who work like me?**

So I created deliberately different synthetic
profiles to stress-test occupational range.

What Kept Showing Up

SYSTEMIC INFORMATION SYNTHESIS

Your answers show a strong instinct to take fragmented, chaotic datasets—like scattered health records—and restructure them into unified, logical systems. You are energized by analytical and editorial decisions that create order out of systemic clutter.

ASYNCHRONOUS SOLITARY CRAFT

You consistently favor self-directed, remote work conditions with low social volume and written collaboration. Deep solo focus in research and writing allows you to produce high-value output without the exhaustion of live performance.

BEHIND-THE-SCENES STORYTELLING

While you select storyteller as a core contribution mode, you pair it with a preference for anonymity and behind-the-scenes building. You aim to clarify complex ideas for others through written or visual artifacts rather than live presentation.

TANGIBLE STRUCTURAL IMPROVEMENT

You are drawn toward making concrete, observable improvements to how systems function. Effort feels worth it when it yields a clear, functional artifact that removes friction for users.

06. THE STRESS TEST

SIX SYNTHETIC PROFILES



HANDS-ON MAKER

Tools · repair · materials · tangible outcomes



VISUAL / SPATIAL CREATIVE

Composition · environments · aesthetics · physical space



FIELD INVESTIGATOR

Observation · evidence · outdoors · physical systems



HUMAN CARE / SUPPORT

People · institutions · navigation · practical support



LIVE OPERATOR / PRODUCER

Logistics · coordination · live execution · moving parts



SCIENTIFIC INVESTIGATOR

Evidence · experiments · precision · technical depth

WHAT I WAS TESTING FOR

01 — RANGE

Would materially different inputs lead the system into materially different occupational territory?

02 — WORK MEDIUM

Would the system distinguish between different ways of being “analytical” — information, machines, environments, or human systems?

03 — OCCUPATIONAL REALISM

Would suggested roles remain recognizable, searchable, and grounded in real work?

Early test outputs weren't consistently archived; this documents the stress-test design rather than reconstructing historical results.

07. ITERATION

THREE CHANGES

Broaden the questionnaire

Added structured options that better recognize physical, spatial, field-based, and hands-on ways of working.

Preserve the work medium

“Analytical” wasn’t specific enough. I separated analysis of information, machines, physical environments, and human systems.

Make occupational language searchable

Added a realism rule: if a role appears in People in This Neighbourhood, a user should be able to search it and find a real occupational world behind it.

People in This Neighbourhood

Real roles where these patterns show up.

Technical Director

This role balances artistic production demands with technical setup, site logistics, and live problem-solving.

Worth noticing: Notice how they balance advance planning with emergency adjustments when equipment or timelines break down on site.

Exhibition Logistics Coordinator

This specialty focuses on moving complex physical structures and systems into place under tight deadlines.

Worth noticing: Notice the software tools, vendor relationships, and site management practices they rely on to maintain clarity.

Field Operations Manager

This practitioner oversees mobile or temporary teams, ensuring that equipment, people, and ownership are clearly aligned in dynamic settings.

Worth noticing: Notice how they establish clear communication protocols and backup options across decentralized teams.

Your Work, Reconsidered

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What Kept Showing Up

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REAL TIME PROBLEM SOLVING

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CREATIVE LOGISTICAL DESIGN

You connect spatial, artistic, and financial elements into practical execution. You prefer applying order to creative or complex experiences like festivals, exhibits, or production sets.

BEHIND THE SCENES OWNERSHIP

You express a willingness to work with ambiguity and low public profile as long as you have real influence over how the machinery runs and can deliver tangible results without bureaucratic fluff.

I came into Worth Exploring from a non-technical background. The technical goal was deliberately modest:

simple · reliable · safe · low-cost · maintainable · enough to test the idea

USER'S BROWSER

Questionnaire responses

VERCEL

Hosts the web application + runs the server-side generation function

GEMINI API

Receives responses + methodology instructions → structured content

WORTH EXPLORING

Personalized report

The API key remains server-side rather than being exposed in the user's browser.

09. CONTRIBUTION

WHAT I DESIGNED

- Product problem
- Methodology
- Questionnaire
- Report architecture
- Inference boundaries
- UX and language
- Testing criteria
- Stress-test profiles
- Occupational realism rules
- Iteration priorities
- What not to build

WHAT THE TOOLS ENABLED

- Gemini model inference
- AI-assisted coding + implementation
- Hosting infrastructure
- Deployment
- Logs + debugging tools
- Web platform services

ENERGY & MECHANICS

STEP 8 OF 16

At the end of a long workday, which type of exhaustion feels most satisfying?

Tangible: I built, made, or fixed something physical/digital I can point to.

Intellectual: I wrestled with a hard abstract problem until my brain hurt.

ENVIRONMENT & STYLE

STEP 9 OF 16

Where is your sweet spot between total freedom and clear structure?



Give me a playbook

Blank canvas

I didn't train a model from scratch. I also didn't ask an AI to "make me a career quiz."

The work has primarily been product judgment: deciding what the system should do, examining what it actually does, and changing the methodology when those things diverge.

GO EXPLORE

Current State

Working product
Publicly launched
Early real-user testing underway

Next Evidence Gate:

Does someone simply recognize themselves in the report —
or does it give them something useful enough to actually explore?

[Try Worth Exploring ↗](#)

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